Akbar then went to visit the saffron fields with Salim, who would remember these visits in his father's company when writing his memoir. The endless fields were harvested and the fragrance was overpowering. Salim wrote that when he visited Kashmir again, the fragrance was so cloying that it gave him and all his close companions a headache. The locals, however, appeared immune and when questioned, 'it was obvious that it had never occurred to them in all their lives to have a headache'. It was October and Diwali was celebrated with enthusiasm. Lamps were lit along the riverbanks, on the boats, and on the roofs of the houses, and 'they presented a splendid appearance'. When in Agra and Fatehpur Sikri, Abu'l Fazl had described how on Diwali 'several cows are adorned and brought before His Majesty. People are very fond of this custom.'

Akbar wanted to remain in Kashmir through the winter but since the soldiery and 'the inhabitants of hot countries' were uncomfortable with the idea, it was decided to return to Lahore. Akbar decided to leave Kashmir in the charge of Khwaja Shamsuddin but Salim petitioned for the reappointment of the disgraced Yusuf Khan Rizvi, who had conspired with other Kashmiri noblemen to rebel against the Mughals. Akbar acquiesced, unwilling to engage in a battle of wills, and Salim thus continued to nurture men whom the Padshah disapproved of, and whom he could bind to his own cause when the need, and the time, arose.

When the Mughal party returned to Lahore, a grand celebration was organized by the ladies of the harem because Salim was to be married to a granddaughter of Mirza Kamran, Humayun's brother. Kamran's daughter, Gulrukh Begum, had asked Akbar permission in the spring of 1592 for her daughter to be married to Salim and now this marriage was celebrated in Hamida Banu's quarters. Salim had always been a favourite of the senior ladies of the harem and in the planning of the wedding there seems to have been a consensus and common purpose between them. Gulrukh Begum, granddaughter of Babur, was clearly a woman of considerable prestige. While her daughter married Salim, her son, Mirza Muzaffar Hussain, later married Akbar's eldest daughter, Khanum Sultan, providing a suitably exalted Timurid lineage for the Padshah's daughter. Mirza Muzaffar Hussain would have a charming garden tomb built for himself immediately adjacent to Humayun's mausoleum. Reclaimed from the neglect of the twentieth century, it has been restored to its serene quietude in the Sundar Nursery grounds today.